



Play with a pom-pom

A simple homemade pom-pom makes a surprisingly versatile toy. It's easy for your baby to hold and drop to develop her grasp reflex, it can be used as a ball, or as a texture toy for her to explore, and it's great for tickling too! Never leave her alone with the pom-pom.

What you need

- ✧ Sheet of paper
- ✧ Cardboard
- ✧ Large ball of brightly colored yarn

Draw a circle 8 in (20cm) in diameter on the paper. Draw a smaller circle in the center approximately 2 in (5cm) in diameter (large enough to thread yarn through). Cut out the template, place it on the cardboard, and cut out two disks with holes in the center.

Place the disks together. Wind the yarn through the center of the disks and around the outsides until they are completely covered in yarn. Repeat at least four times for a fluffy pom-pom.

Insert a pair of scissors between the outside edges of the cardboard disks and cut through the yarn.

Slide a separate length of yarn between the disks, pull tightly around the center of the wrapped yarn, and secure in a firm knot. Cut away the disks and fluff up the pom-pom.

